choices. It is about more than GNP growth, more than income and wealth and more than producing commodities and accumulating capital. A person's access to income may be one of the choice, but it is not the sum total of human behaviour". It viewed human development as "a process of enlarging people's choices. The most critical of these wide-ranging choices are to live a long and healthy life, to be educated and to have access to resources needed for a decent standard of living. Additional choices include political freedom, guaranteed human rights and personal self-respect". The 1990 report introduced the Human Development Index (HDI) and identified three essential elements as essential to human life: *life expectancy*, *knowledge*, and *decent standard of living*. Subsequent Human Development Reports have led to the broadening of the concept of development.

The Human Development Report 1995 talked about gender equality and it stated, "human development if not engendered is endangered". Further, the 1997 Human Development Report considered poverty eradication to be the prime objective of human development. It not only looked at poverty from the perspectives of income, basic needs and capacity but also outlined the criteria of ill-being which is inevitable for assessing capacity-building and measurement of well-being. This included criteria like being disabled, lacking land, livestock, etc., being unable to bury their dead ones, being "poor in people" lacking social support, having to accept demeaning low status work and others. Another aspect of this report was the preparation of Human Poverty Index (HPI-1) and (HPI-2) for the developed and the developing countries, respectively. Considering the three elements of human life as prescribed by the Human Development Index, the HPI highlighted deprivation of these three elements in the form of deprivation related to:

1. Survival—vulnerability to death at a relatively early age.
2. Knowledge—being excluded from the world of reading and communication.
3. Decent living.

The Human Development Report of 2003 was a reflection of a pledge by the international community to combat poverty and